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The question that gets everyone to say Yes

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Hello Curious Minds,

Week 28. Still here. Still curious. Thanks for reading 2378+ Subscribers.

Last week we had a tree plantation drive. Instead of asking "Want to join?" I asked "Would it be a bad idea to join?"

The responses?

- "Why would this be a bad idea? :)"
- "I badly wanted this nudge! I'm there!"
- "Not a bad idea at all. Count me in next time!"

I used this question on purpose. Wanted to see what happens when you flip the script.

Turns out, a lot.

The Flip

We're all trying to get someone to say yes. Every day.

Your boss. Your kids. Your friends.

Most of us do it wrong.

Wrong way: "Want to grab coffee?" **Right way:** "Would it be bad to grab coffee?"

See it? The second question makes them argue FOR coffee, not against it.

Wrong way: "Should we meet for 30 minutes?" **Right way:** "Should we meet for an hour, or is 30 better?"

That first number (60) makes 30 feel quick.

Start Tiny

Netflix didn't ask you to watch 10 seasons. They said "Just one episode."

I didn't ask you to read my thoughts forever. Just one Sunday email.

One yes leads to the next yes.

Three Rules

1. **Give first** - Make this useful before asking for anything
2. **Make it easy** - Small steps, clear choices
3. **Be straight** - People smell BS from miles away

Your Turn

Try the flip once this week.

Instead of asking what you want, ask if NOT doing it would be silly.

Hit reply. Tell me what happens.

(And yes, that's me getting you to engage. You see it now, right?)

Stay curious, Vikas Surani

2,000+ people get this every Sunday. Forward it if it helped.

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Shyam Bajaniya  • 1st

Business Development | IT Services (Web, Shopify, SEO, Ads) | Or...

5mo ...

This is exactly why negotiation trainers say don't start with yes/no questions give options that frame the desired one as the easiest (Yes).

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5mo ...

Shyam Bajaniya Absolutely, Shyam! Framing the options really does shift the conversation and lowers resistance. It's fascinating how a small tweak in how we ask can make such a big difference in outcomes—whether in negotiation or everyday life. Thanks for sharing your perspective!

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